

Alenio App Update & Version Release Process

Use this checklist every time you ship a new mobile build. In-app release notes come only from Railway. The App Store / Play Store listing also shows What's New when users update.

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What the system does

- Soft update prompt: users below `MOBILE_LATEST_VERSION` see Update available with Railway bullets, Update now, and Later.
- Force update (optional): users below `MOBILE_MINIMUM_VERSION` must update (no Later). Keep at 0.0.0 until you need it.
- Update now opens `IOS_APP_STORE_URL` or `ANDROID_PLAY_STORE_URL`. Store pages show their own What's New copy.
- There is no second in-app What's New modal after install.

Where to edit notes

- In-app Update available bullets: Railway `MOBILE_UPDATE_BULLETS` (and optional `MOBILE_UPDATE_TITLE`)
- Store listing What's New: App Store Connect / Google Play Console when you submit the build

Files & Railway variables

Mobile (in the repo)

- `mobile/app.json` - `expo.version` (example: 1.0.04) and `iOS buildNumber` / `Android versionCode` as needed

Railway (Alenio Backend - Prod)

- `MOBILE_LATEST_VERSION` - store version users should be on (must match the new `app.json` version)
- `MOBILE_MINIMUM_VERSION` - usually 0.0.0; raise only to force-update broken builds
- `MOBILE_UPDATE_BULLETS` - bullets for the Update available screen (pipe | or newlines)
- `MOBILE_UPDATE_TITLE` - optional title on the update modal
- `IOS_APP_STORE_URL` - `https://apps.apple.com/app/idYOUR_APP_ID`
- `ANDROID_PLAY_STORE_URL` - `https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.vibecode.alenio9iqp9v`

Full release process (do in order)

Step 1. Bump the app version

- Open `mobile/app.json`
- Change `expo.version` to the new version (e.g. 1.0.03 -> 1.0.04)
- Bump `iOS buildNumber` and `Android versionCode` if your store process requires it

Step 2. Write store What's New

- In App Store Connect / Play Console, write the listing What's New for this release
- Users see that on the store page when they tap Update now

Step 3. Build & submit to the stores

- Create the iOS / Android store builds (EAS or your usual pipeline)

- Submit and wait until the new version is available on the App Store / Play Store
- Do NOT set MOBILE_LATEST_VERSION on Railway until the store listing is live

Step 4. Set Railway update prompt (for users still on old builds)

- In Railway -> Alenio Backend Prod -> Variables, set the values below
- No trailing spaces in variable NAMES
- Redeploy / restart the backend after changing variables so they take effect

```
MOBILE_LATEST_VERSION=1.0.04
MOBILE_MINIMUM_VERSION=0.0.0
MOBILE_UPDATE_TITLE=What's new in this update
MOBILE_UPDATE_BULLETS=Bullet one|Bullet two|Bullet three
IOS_APP_STORE_URL=https://apps.apple.com/app/idYOUR_APP_ID
ANDROID_PLAY_STORE_URL=https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.vibecode.alenio9i
qp9v
```

Step 5. Verify the API

- Open: <https://alenio-backend-production.up.railway.app/api/app-version>
- Confirm latestVersion, bullets, and store URLs look correct

```
{"data":{"latestVersion":"1.0.04","minimumVersion":"0.0.0","bullets":["..."],"iosStoreUrl":"...","androidStoreUrl":"..."}}
```

Step 6. What users experience

- Old build: Update available with Railway bullets; Update now opens the store; Later dismisses until the next latestVersion change
- On the store page they see the listing What's New you wrote in App Store Connect / Play Console
- After install they go straight into the app - no second in-app What's New modal

Force update (only when needed)

If a bad build must be blocked, set MOBILE_MINIMUM_VERSION to the lowest version still allowed (e.g. 1.0.04). Anyone below that sees Update required with no Later button. Use carefully - this blocks the app.

Testing checklist (dev)

- Temporarily set MOBILE_LATEST_VERSION higher than your installed app and set MOBILE_UPDATE_BULLETS
- Redeploy backend; confirm /api/app-version
- Reload the signed-in app - soft prompt should appear with Update now and Later
- Later dismisses; bump latestVersion again to re-show
- Reset test vars when done

Common mistakes

- Setting MOBILE_LATEST_VERSION before the store build is live
- Forgetting to redeploy Railway after changing env vars
- Typos or trailing spaces in variable names
- Mismatch between app.json version and MOBILE_LATEST_VERSION